Sahyadri Public Library - Annual Report 2025-26

Reporting period: 1 April 2025 to 31 March 2026. This is a sample report written for practising document question answering. The library, the people and all numbers in it are made up.

1. Message from the Chief Librarian

Dear members and friends of the library, 2025-26 was the year our library became truly digital while staying a warm place to read and learn. We opened our third branch in Kothrud, launched the Sahyadri Reads mobile app and welcomed more than 2,000 new members. I want to thank our 38 staff members and 120 volunteers, who made all of this possible. - Dr. Kavita Deshpande, Chief Librarian

The library was founded in 1962 by a group of teachers in Pune. Today it has three branches: the Central Library on FC Road, the Aundh branch (opened 1998) and the new Kothrud branch (opened 15 August 2025). Our mission is simple: free access to knowledge for everyone in the city, whatever their age or income.

2. Membership

At the end of March 2026 the library had 18,450 active members, up from 16,200 a year earlier, an increase of about 14 percent. 2,310 new members joined during the year, and about 60 members cancelled or did not renew.

Membership type	Yearly fee	Books at a time	Members (March 2026)
Student (up to 21 years)	Rs. 300	4	6,820
Adult	Rs. 800	6	9,150
Senior citizen (60+)	Free	6	2,140
Family (up to 4 people)	Rs. 2,000	15	340 families

Membership is free for senior citizens since 1 June 2025, after a decision of the library board. Students need a valid school or college ID card. The joining process takes about 10 minutes at any branch, or can be done in the Sahyadri Reads app with Aadhaar-based verification.

3. Collection and Borrowing

The library's collection grew to 2,14,000 items: 1,72,000 printed books, 9,500 magazines and journals, 26,000 e-books and 6,500 audiobooks. 11,800 new printed books were bought during the year, about 40 percent of them in Marathi, 35 percent in English and 25 percent in Hindi and other languages.

Members borrowed 3,12,000 printed items during the year, an average of 17 items per member. The most borrowed categories were children's books (24 percent of all loans), fiction (21 percent) and competitive exam preparation books (14 percent). The single most borrowed book was a Marathi translation of a popular science book for children.

Rules for borrowing: books can be borrowed for 21 days and renewed twice online if nobody else has reserved them. The late fee is Rs. 2 per book per day, with a maximum of Rs. 100 per book. Lost books must be replaced or paid for at the current price plus a Rs. 50 processing fee. Reference books and the rare manuscripts collection cannot be borrowed and must be read inside the library.

4. Digital Services

The Sahyadri Reads mobile app was launched on 26 January 2026 for Android and iOS. Members can search the catalogue, reserve and renew books, read e-books, listen to audiobooks and get a digital membership card. By 31 March 2026 the app had been downloaded 9,400 times and had about 5,100 monthly active users.

E-book and audiobook loans grew strongly: 48,600 digital loans in 2025-26 compared to 21,300 the year before. E-books can be borrowed for 14 days, and each member can have up to 3 e-books at the same time.

Free Wi-Fi is available at all three branches. The Central Library also has a digital lab with 30 computers, a 3D printer and a scanner that members can use for free for up to 2 hours per day. The lab is open from 10 AM to 7 PM.

5. Programmes and Events

The library organised 410 events during the year with a total attendance of about 26,000 people. The most popular programmes were the Saturday storytelling sessions for children, the free coding club for teenagers, and the monthly author talks.

The Summer Reading Challenge (April to June 2025) had 3,200 participants. Children who read at least 10 books got a certificate, and 1,150 children completed the challenge. The Digital Literacy for Seniors programme trained 640 senior citizens to use smartphones, UPI payments and video calls, in 32 batches of about 20 people.

A new Career Corner was opened at the Aundh branch in September 2025. It has books and online courses for competitive exams such as UPSC, MPSC and banking exams, and it offers free weekly mock tests every Sunday morning.

6. Opening Hours and Branches

Branch	Address area	Opening hours	Weekly holiday
Central Library	FC Road	8 AM - 9 PM	None (open all week)
Aundh branch	Aundh	9 AM - 8 PM	Monday
Kothrud branch	Kothrud	10 AM - 8 PM	Tuesday

All branches are closed on 26 January, 15 August, 2 October and on Diwali (Lakshmi Pujan day). The reading hall of the Central Library stays open until 11 PM during the exam season in March and April, because many students use it.

The Kothrud branch was built in 18 months at a cost of Rs. 4.2 crore, of which Rs. 3 crore came from the Pune Municipal Corporation and Rs. 1.2 crore from donations. It has a children's section, a quiet reading hall with 120 seats and a rooftop garden for reading.

7. Finances

Total income in 2025-26 was Rs. 6.8 crore, and total spending was Rs. 6.5 crore, so the library ended the year with a surplus of Rs. 30 lakh, which goes into the building maintenance fund.

Income source	Amount (Rs.)	Spending area	Amount (Rs.)
Government grants	3.9 crore	Staff salaries	3.1 crore
Membership fees	1.1 crore	New books and digital content	1.4 crore
Donations and CSR	1.5 crore	Buildings and utilities	1.2 crore
Other (events, late fees, lab)	0.3 crore	Programmes and technology	0.8 crore

The largest single donation was Rs. 50 lakh from the Patwardhan Family Trust for the children's section at Kothrud. Income from late fees was only Rs. 4.5 lakh, because the library prefers to send reminders instead of charging fees.

8. Plans for 2026-27

The library board approved four main goals for the next year:

1. Open a small fourth branch in Hadapsar by March 2027, focused on students and working people. 2. Grow the digital collection to 40,000 e-books and audiobooks. 3. Introduce self-service kiosks for borrowing and returning books at all branches, so members do not have to wait in queues. 4. Start a home delivery service for senior citizens and people with disabilities, starting with 500 members in a pilot.

The planned budget for 2026-27 is Rs. 7.4 crore. Members can send suggestions to suggestions@sahyadrilibrary.example or drop them in the suggestion box at any branch. The next members' annual meeting will be held on 20 June 2026 at the Central Library.